



Western Digital Scorpio Blue 500GB

High-capacity storage coupled with a high price-tag!



Western Digital joins the race of the ever-expanding portable notebook hard drives with its Scorpio Blue 500 GB. All this space is packed into a 9.5 mm height body; making it compatible with most of the laptops. It uses WD's anti-shock protection measures to reduce chances of damage. During the testing, the drive ran silently and vibrations were at a bare minimum.

It took the drive just 50 seconds to write a 4 GB single file and 61 seconds for a 4 GB folder with assorted files. It read a 4 GB file at 75 seconds and the 4 GB assorted folder at 81 seconds. In the internal file copy

test, it took 186 seconds and 204 seconds for a 4 GB single file and 4 GB assorted folder respectively. Comparing it to the Seagate Momentus 5400.6 500GB drive, there are tests where both of them have. But in general, the performances

of these drives aren't drastically different.

We were almost shocked to find that maximum retail price of this drive is a whopping Rs. 10,950. The Seagate Momentus 5400.6 in comparison is for nearly half that price. The Scorpio Blue may be a decent performer but the difference in price difference doesn't make very good sense.

HDtch 32MB	
Average Read (MBps)	67.9
Average Write (MBps)	63.3
CPU Utilization (%)	4
Random Access Time (ms)	16.1
Read Burst Speed (MBps)	228.3
SiSoft Sandra 2008 Engineer's Edition	
Drive Index, Read (MBps)	63.8
Access Time, Read (ms)	14
Drive Index, Write (MBps)	64.41
Access Time, Write (ms)	5

RATINGS

Features.....	7
Build Quality	7.5
Performance.....	7
Value for money	4
Overall	6.5

Contact

Western Digital Corporation
Email: Amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Phone: +91-93210 29204
Price: Rs. 10,950

Specifications

Capacity: 500GB
Size: 2.5 inches
Rotational Speed: 5400 RPM
Buffer Size: 8 MB
Interface: SATA
Dimensions: 100 x 69.85 x 9.5 mm
Weight: 117 g

ASUS SDRW-08D1S-U

Optical companion for your netbook

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-67668800
Email: media_india@asus.com
Web site: www.asus.in
Price: Rs. 3,500

Specifications

Maximum Write speed:
 8x (DVD), 24x (CD)
Data Buffer: 2 MB
Dimensions: 156.4 x 140.8 x 21 mm
Weight: 412 g

RATINGS

Features	7
Performance	6
Build quality	7
Value for money	6.5
Overall	6.5

The Asus SDRW-08D1S-U is a slim, portable external DVD-writer. It comes in a two cool looking colours - black and white. It compliments the look of Asus's Eee PC netbooks. Because of its thin profile, it can be slid into a side-pocket of a bag. The build quality is pretty decent and the eject button is tactile. Closing the tray gave a firm affirmation of our action. The drive can be used either horizontally or mounted vertically on the provided mounting stand. It has a miniUSB port at the back and is supplied with a Y-type USB cable. The drive comes bundled with Cyberlink's CD authoring software; it is not the full-blown version though. It will let you

write only data discs and rip audio CDs to MP3 - nothing that freely available software out there can't do.

To test it, we burnt a single 4.3 GB file onto a DVD which took eleven-and-a-half minutes. Then, we copied an assortment of files amounting to 4.3 GB. It took almost exactly the same time as the single file. According to our read tests, it took take around ten minutes to copy an entire 4.3 GB DVD onto the test PCs hard drive. Being a laptop optical drive on the inside, an average performance from this device is expected and that's what we got. At Rs. 3,500, the drive's price is somewhat okay. This product can be handy for people owning netbooks or nettops where



no DVD writers are provided. It might also work for HTPCs where the case doesn't have enough space to hold a large DVD drive. It's not very easy to find something this compact either. We give it our thumbs up.